

ACHIEVE!

HISTORY



World War II

Book 1

Jennifer MacDonald



Made for the
Australian Curriculum

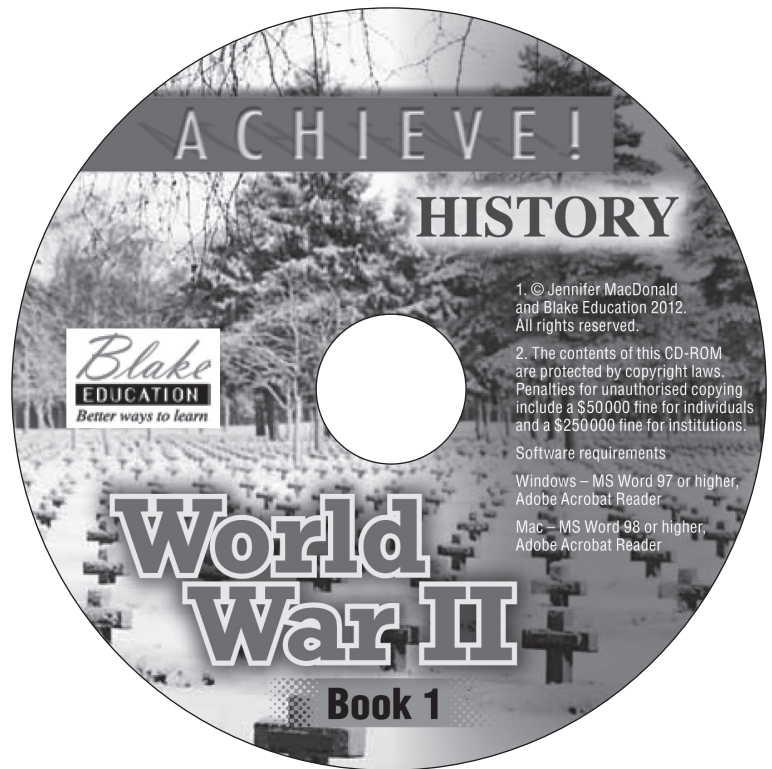


Achieve! History

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- ✓ Activities designed to reinforce and enhance literacy skills
- ✓ Emphasis on understanding essential History content
- ✓ Comprehensive Teacher's Notes, providing clear objectives, background information, starter and extension activities
- ✓ CD-ROM containing all the pages from the book that can be used on the Interactive Whiteboard
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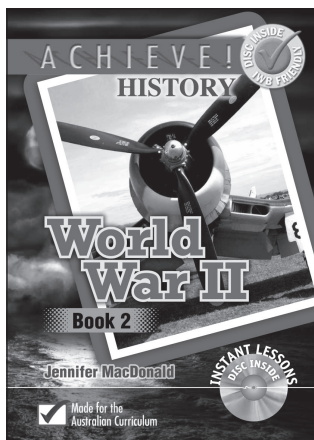
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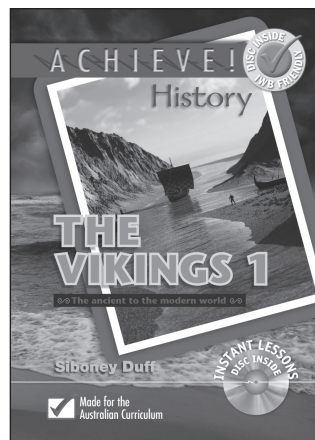
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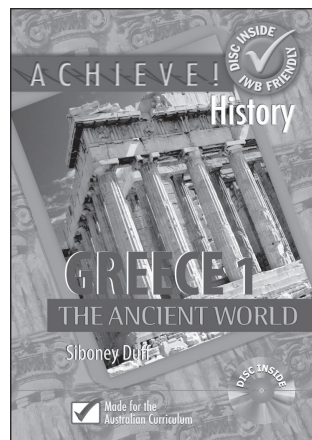
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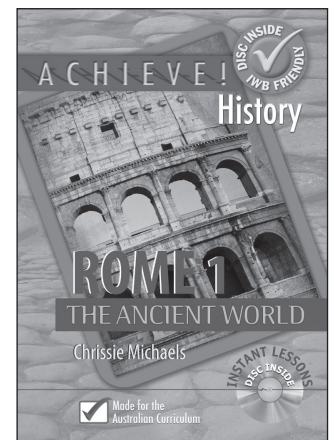
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ACHIEVE!
HISTORY

World War II

Book 1

Jennifer MacDonald

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Jennifer MacDonald has more than twenty years' experience teaching, including teaching English and History in secondary schools and TAFEs in Australia and overseas. She has written resource material on understanding genres for the NSW Department of Education and Training. Jennifer has presented at a number of curriculum workshops. She is particularly interested in different learning styles and in making curriculums more accessible for marginal students. Jennifer has also taught Professional Writing within the adult education sector and is a published poet.

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ABN 50 074 266 023
108 Main Road
Clayton South VIC 3169
Ph: +61 3 9558 4433
info@blake.com.au
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The *Achieve!* series of History titles has been developed for teachers who require modified, curriculum-focused activities for secondary school students who struggle to read and comprehend regular classroom materials because of poor literacy skills. Many of the pages will also be suitable as supplementary material for regular classes.

World War II – Book 1 looks at the causes of the war, explores main events and studies the effect of the war on Australia. Content includes the Treaty of Versailles, the rise of the Nazi Party and the Holocaust. Different perspectives about Australia's involvement in the war are studied, along with the experiences of those on the home front, including the role of women, the introduction of rationing, conscription, censorship and the response to the threat of a Japanese invasion. Historical and literacy skills are developed through interpreting photographs and secondary sources, locating and categorising information and studying the impacts of the wartime experience.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the individual needs of students.

This book is divided into ten units, containing photocopiable Resource sheets and Activity sheets. This will allow teachers to use the material in a variety of ways. For example, the unit could be taught as a lesson with students in groups of varying sizes. Alternatively, a single Resource sheet and related Activity sheets can be used as support material, for individual homework, assessment or revision.

The teacher's notes provide valuable guidance about using each unit, and contain the following elements:

Objectives – These are the key skills and knowledge learnt through using the work sheets.

Prior knowledge – This refers to the skills and knowledge required for students to complete the tasks. Some activities are more challenging than others. However, as a rule, students should have a reading comprehension age of six to nine years to be able to attempt the activities.

Background – This section provides additional guidance to help teachers to present a successful lesson. It may include definitions or further background notes about the subject matter.

Starter activity – Warm-up activities are provided to put the content into proper context and to gain student interest and attention.

Resource and Activity sheets – The Resource sheets do not always contain activities and are used either to stimulate discussion or as a part of the unit's activities. The Activity sheets may be used sequentially or as stand-alone tasks, depending on the needs of the students.

Extension ideas – Additional tasks are suggested to recap the main skills or knowledge taught in the lesson, or to extend, assess or include technology in the lesson.

The Australian Curriculum correlations	Unit									
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
An overview of the causes and course of World War II (ACDSEH024)	✓	✓	✓	✓						
An examination of significant events of World War II, including the Holocaust and use of the atomic bomb (ACDSEH107)					✓	✓				
The experiences of Australians during World War II (such as Prisoners of War (POWs), the Battle of Britain, Kokoda, the Fall of Singapore) (ACDSEH108)									✓	
The impact of World War II, with a particular emphasis on the Australian home front, including the changing roles of women and use of wartime government controls (conscription, manpower controls, rationing and censorship) (ACDSEH109)							✓	✓	✓	✓
The significance of World War II to Australia's international relationships in the twentieth century, with particular reference to the United Nations, Britain, the USA and Asia (ACDSEH110)										

Australian Curriculum

Objectives

- To recognise German discontent with the Treaty of Versailles
- To develop an awareness of how the Great Depression contributed to WWII
- To understand the meanings of key words.

Prior knowledge

Students need to have an understanding of World War I, and the nations that fought on the different sides.

Background

At the start of World War I (WWI) in 1914, Britain, France and Russia were allies. These nations formed the Triple Entente (Allied powers). Australia fought with them. Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy formed the Triple Alliance (Axis powers). Italy changed sides during the war. The USA entered WWI in 1917 and fought with Britain, France and Russia. WWI was won by the Allied powers and Germany was defeated.

The Treaty of Versailles was signed in 1919. The newly formed Weimar Republic (government established in Germany after WWI) became increasingly unpopular with Germans because it had signed the treaty which demanded they pay Allied nations, especially France and Belgium, millions of dollars in war reparations. This discontent was seized upon by the newly formed Nazi Party.

The Great Depression created international financial and social insecurity. Resultant unemployment helped Hitler and Mussolini rise to power. Japan, Germany and Italy increased territorial acquisitions to secure raw materials. Other nations could not afford to successfully implement sanctions to prevent this empire building.

Starter activity

Write these country names on the board: Austria-Hungary, Britain, France, Germany, Russia, Italy. Work with the students to identify which nations belonged to the Triple Entente (Allied powers) and which belonged to the Triple Alliance (Axis powers). Remind students that each group was trying to prevent the other from building up military powers and annexing land, and that other nations fought with these groups.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'The Treaty of Versailles', provides background information on the Treaty of Versailles, the treaty's demands on Germany and Germany's reaction. Read the sheet with the students and make sure they understand the meaning of each term shown in bold.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Understanding the Treaty of Versailles', students will need the Resource sheet, 'The Treaty of Versailles', and a dictionary. Students will write definitions and complete a cloze activity to check their comprehension of the information on the Resource sheet.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Newspaper headlines', students need to refer to a newspaper or online news site. Students choose the three most interesting headlines from the newspaper. Then they write three headlines of their own about the Treaty of Versailles from the perspectives of journalists from different nations. You could extend the activity by asking students to write the first few paragraphs in the news articles for the German and French journalists, or a journalist from another nation of their own choosing.

The Resource sheet, 'The Great Depression and insecurity', outlines how high unemployment, territorial expansion and a policy of appeasement contributed to WWII. Read the sheet with the students, and discuss the meaning of each term in bold. You could locate the countries mentioned on a world map.

The Activity sheet, 'Understanding the Great Depression', asks students to recall basic information from the Resource sheet, 'The Great Depression and insecurity', and to fill in a timeline.

Extension idea

- Divide students into small groups and ask them to imagine they are at the Versailles Peace Conference. Have them present arguments about whether or not Germany should have to pay war reparations, and if so, how much they should pay.

The Treaty of Versailles

Soon after World War I (WWI) ended, a number of world leaders met to officially end the war. This meeting was called the Paris Peace Conference. It was held at Versailles Palace, near Paris. One purpose of the conference was to make Germany pay **war damages**. The most powerful nations represented at this conference were Britain, France, the United States of America, Italy and Japan. William Hughes, the Australian Prime Minister, also attended. Germany was not invited.

Germany believed the **peace treaty** would be based on a fourteen-point plan developed by Woodrow Wilson (President of the USA) aimed at keeping world peace. France thought this plan was not severe enough – they wanted Germany to accept blame for starting WWI.

After much debate, the Treaty of Versailles was signed on the 28th of June, 1919. This treaty included a **war guilt clause** and Germany had to accept blame for starting WWI. Germany also had to pay millions of **pounds** to some Allied nations, especially France.

The Treaty of Versailles demanded that:

- Germany pay huge war **reparations**.
- Germany restrict the growth of its **military forces**.
- Germany decrease its **territory**.

Allied nations at the end of WWI

- Australia
- Britain
- Canada
- France
- Italy
- Japan
- Russia
- United States of America

How did Germany react to The Treaty of Versailles?

Many Germans felt that the Treaty of Versailles was too severe. The huge war reparations Germany had to pay meant Germany's economy suffered. Extreme groups in Germany promised they could make Germany a better nation.

The Nazi Party was formed in 1919 and Adolf Hitler became the party's leader in 1921. He promised to overturn the losses Germany experienced as a result of the Treaty of Versailles.

Understanding the Treaty of Versailles

 You need the Resource sheet, 'The Treaty of Versailles', and a dictionary to answer the following questions.

1 Use a dictionary to help you write a definition for each word.

a reparations _____

b restrict _____

c severe _____

d decrease _____

e territory _____

f treaty _____

g blamed _____

2 Use the words from question 1 to complete the following information.

On the 28th of June, 1919, the Treaty of Versailles was signed. Germany thought that the Treaty was too _____. The _____ of Versailles had a clause in it that _____ Germany for starting WWI. As a result of this treaty, Germany had to _____ the growth of her military forces and _____ its _____. Germany also was forced to pay huge war _____.

3 Name the Australian Prime Minister who attended the Paris Peace Conference.

4 Name three powerful nations that were represented at the Paris Peace Conference.

5 List three countries that were allied nations in WWI.

6 Who became leader of the Nazi Party in 1921? _____

Newspaper headlines

Headlines in newspapers tell us what an article will be about. Headlines are short and use words that capture the reader's attention, as you can see in the example at the right.

Germany forced to pay back millions

-  **1** Look at a newspaper and find the three headlines you think are most interesting. Write them below.

--	--	--

- 2** Imagine you are a journalist, reporting on the signing of the Treaty of Versailles. Think about the opinions of journalists from different countries. What headline do you think these journalists would write? You can use the word bank to help.

A German journalist	Word bank Germany sign Britain Australia plan France USA Treaty defeat World War 1 Versailles pay met huge reparations punished severe blame accept
A French journalist	
An Australian journalist	

- 3** Now, as an Australian journalist, write the first paragraph of your news article.

The Great Depression and insecurity

A depression is a severe slump in an economy. Businesses find it hard to make any profit and people lose their jobs. On 24th October, 1929, the New York stock market crashed. This marked the beginning of the Great Depression and it continued into the 1930s.

The Great Depression spread to other countries. Some countries decided they needed more land to supply raw materials to help their industries survive. Japan invaded Manchuria in 1931. Italy invaded Abyssinia in 1935. Germany invaded parts of Eastern Europe.

During the Great Depression there was very high unemployment, which created a feeling of insecurity (not being safe). Many people were poor.



In some countries, people turned to leaders who promised to make their nations strong. These leaders built up their supplies of arms (weapons) and tried to take land that belonged to other nations. Adolf Hitler from Germany and Benito Mussolini from Italy were two such leaders.

Policy of appeasement

In the 1930s, France and Britain decided the Treaty of Versailles was too harsh on Germany. They followed a policy of **appeasement** (compromise in the hope of avoiding another war). In 1938, Germany, France, Britain and Italy signed the Munich Agreement, which agreed to Hitler's claim that part of Czechoslovakia belonged to Germany. Neville Chamberlain, the British Prime Minister, believed Hitler would not claim any more territory but in March 1939 Hitler invaded all of Czechoslovakia.

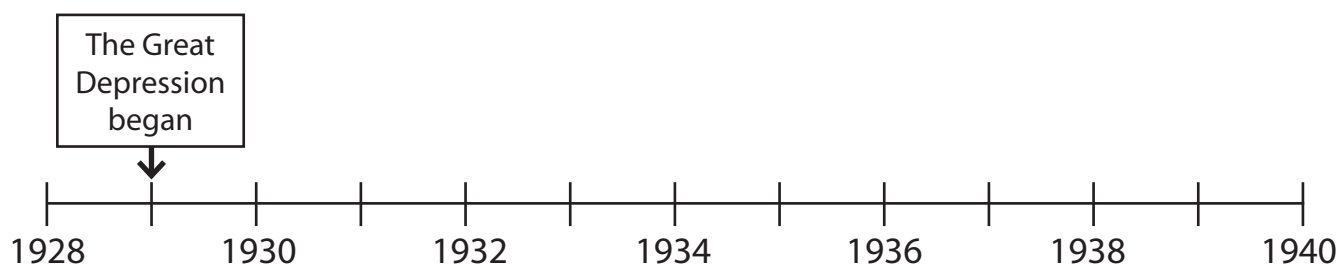
Some historians argue that the Great Depression contributed to the policy of appeasement because Allied nations were not in a financial position to stop Hitler's **imperialism**. The financial losses caused by the Great Depression also meant that France and Britain did not put as much money into building up their supplies of weapons.

Understanding the Great Depression

 You need the Resource sheet, 'The Great Depression and insecurity', to answer the following questions.

- 1 A depression occurs when _____
- 2 During the Great Depression, there was very high _____
- 3 Insecurity is a feeling of _____
- 4 In the 1930s, France and Britain followed a policy of _____
- 5 In 1939, the British Prime Minister was _____

A **timeline** is a diagram that records the order in which events happened.



- 6 Fill in the timeline above with the following events. The first event is already recorded. You can put events above or below the timeline.
 - The date the Great Depression began
 - The date Japan invaded Manchuria
 - The date Italy invaded Abyssinia
 - The date the Munich Agreement was signed
- 7 Look at the illustration on the Resource sheet. The man is using cardboard to repair his shoes. Why do you think he is doing this?

Objectives

- To develop a basic understanding of totalitarianism
- To identify Hitler and Mussolini as dictators
- To gain an awareness of Japanese ambitions
- To examine primary source photos

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

The term *totalitarianism*, was first used in the 1920s in reference to Italian Fascists. It is a political system that attempts to completely control both public and private life. Totalitarian governments control the media and use propaganda to promote their ideologies. They also rigorously control any opposition. Often totalitarian states are led by charismatic leaders who are dictators. Totalitarianism is not always synonymous with dictatorships; however, Hitler and Mussolini were dictators who formed totalitarian states.

In the 1930s, Mussolini and Hitler worked towards developing totalitarian states. Mussolini aimed to restore Italy to her ancient glory. Under his leadership, Italy invaded Abyssinia in 1935 and Albania in 1939. Hitler's aim was to stop Germany paying further war reparations. He also wanted to increase German territory to create more living space for German nationals and to create the perfect Aryan race.

Starter activity

Write the word *totalitarianism* on the board. Explain to the students that totalitarianism is a political system that believes the government should have total control over people's public and personal lives.

Divide the board into two columns. In the first column, list other major systems of government. In the second column write a definition of each system (examples shown below).

System	Definition
Democracy	The people or the people's elected representatives govern.
Socialism	The means of production is mostly owned by the state to benefit the majority.
Communism	A system that is opposed to individuals owning capital.

Encourage the students to share their opinions about each system of government.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Totalitarianism', provides a cloze activity explaining what totalitarianism is, and which nations had totalitarian governments in 1939.

Read the Resource sheet, 'Adolf Hitler', with the students and ensure they understand the meanings of the terms in bold. This sheet outlines Hitler's rise to power and his relationship with the Nazi Party, and introduces Hitler's doctrine of the perfect race. A primary source in the form of a photo of Hitler is also provided.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Adolf Hitler and a primary source', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'Adolf Hitler'. Students will answer comprehension questions about the information on the resource sheet, and respond to the photo of Hitler.

Read the Resource sheet, 'Benito Mussolini', with the students and ensure they understand the meanings of the terms in bold. This sheet provides background information on Mussolini, his rise to power and his dictatorship. A primary source in the form of a photo of Mussolini and Hitler is also provided.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Hitler and Mussolini', students will need to refer to the Resource sheets, 'Adolf Hitler' and 'Benito Mussolini'. Students will complete a Venn diagram comparing Hitler and Mussolini, and write three observations about the photo of Mussolini and Hitler. To extend the activity, you could ask students to write sentences about the similarities between Hitler and Mussolini.

Extension ideas

Students could go to this website: www.fresno.k12.ca.us/divdept/ssscience/history/totalitarianism.htm to learn more about the rise of totalitarianism. Guide the students' reading by providing questions for them to answer, such as:

What type of dictatorship was set up in Japan by 1932? (Answer: a military dictatorship)

Why did Japan want an overseas empire? (Answer: to gain raw materials)

What north-eastern Chinese province did Japan invade? (Answer: Manchuria)

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

What is totalitarianism?

 1 Use the word bank to complete the information below.

Totalitarianism is a system of government that aims for total _____. This means that the _____ has complete and unrestricted power over people's _____ and private lives.

The military and secret _____ help totalitarian leaders stay in power by forcing people to _____ them. It is very _____ for people to disagree with a totalitarian government because they could be put into _____ or killed. People don't have any _____.

Artists and _____ are censored. This means they are not _____ to paint and write whatever they want. Often, artists have to create images to _____ people to believe that everything the government does is _____. Writers also have to promote the government.

Before World War II began in 1939, there were _____ main totalitarian countries – Germany, _____ and Japan. Germany was governed by Adolf _____ and the Nazi Party. Italy was governed by Benito Mussolini. _____ was governed by a military dictatorship.

Word bank

allowed
control
dangerous
freedom
jail
government
Hitler
Italy
Japan
obey
persuade
police
public
right
three
writers

Adolf Hitler

Adolf Hitler gained political power by promising to improve the German economy and restore Germany to her former glory.

Why people supported Hitler

Hitler was a **charismatic** leader. He could capture people's imaginations and persuade people to believe in him. He was also a skilful **orator**. He could give inspiring speeches that attracted large crowds.

In 1921, Hitler became the leader of the Nazi party. He became the German Chancellor (head of the German government) in 1933. Once in power, Hitler banned all opposition. He used the secret police and the military to **quash** anyone who opposed him. He referred to his one-party government as the Third Reich. He called himself Führer, which is German for 'the leader'.

Hitler's goals

Hitler aimed to establish a perfect, superior race. He believed real Germans descended from the Aryans. The Aryans were people with blonde hair and blue eyes. Hitler wanted to rid Germany of Jewish people because he thought they were inferior. He sent millions of Jewish and other non-Aryan people to concentration camps.

Hitler used **propaganda** to spread his beliefs. Propaganda is misleading or incorrect information that persuades people to believe what you want them to believe. Hitler used propaganda to promote his ideas about the perfect race and explain why millions of Jews and non-Aryan people should be persecuted.

In 1939 Hitler invaded Poland because he wanted more land for his expanding **empire**. It was this event that sparked WWII.

Hitler was a **dictator** – he governed with absolute power.



German Chancellor Adolf Hitler
giving a speech, July 1940
Courtesy, Australian War Memorial
P02018.015

Adolf Hitler and a primary source

 You need the Resource sheet, 'Adolf Hitler', to answer the following questions.

1 Write each term beside the correct definition:

banned, descended, expanding, inferior, sparked, superior.

Terms	Definitions
	did not allow
	came from
	growing
	started
	not as good as
	better than

2 In what year did Hitler become the Nazi Party leader? _____

3 What two things did Hitler use to quash opposition?

4 What sort of race did Hitler want to establish?

5 What did Hitler use to spread his beliefs? _____

6 In what year did Hitler invade Poland? _____

7 Look at the photo on the Resource sheet and read the caption. The photo is **primary evidence** because it was taken at the time Hitler was giving the speech.

Write three things that you notice about this photo. For example, you could write about the way Hitler is standing.

- _____
- _____
- _____

Benito Mussolini

Benito Mussolini was an Italian who dreamt of returning Italy to her ancient glory. He began the **Italian Fascist Party** and was its leader.

In 1922, King Victor Emmanuel of Italy appointed Mussolini as Italian Prime Minister. Mussolini was the youngest man ever to hold this position. Once in power, Mussolini quickly became a **dictator**.

Why many Italians supported Mussolini

After WWI, Italy was in chaos. Many Italians believed Mussolini could improve Italy's economy and bring stability to Italy. To help solve the problem of unemployment, Mussolini started rebuilding Italy's roads and public transport system which provided many jobs. Like Adolf Hitler, Mussolini had a **charismatic** personality. He was a brilliant public speaker.

Mussolini and the League of Nations

The **League of Nations** was established at the end of WWI. Its aim was to promote international cooperation between nations and keep peace. Mussolini ignored the League's attempts to resolve Italy's land claims in Abyssinia. Instead of accepting some Abyssinian land, Italy invaded Abyssinia in 1935. The League imposed **trade sanctions** on Italy because of this military action. This meant that Italy could not easily import or export goods. However, these trade sanctions were not really enforced and Italy continued its expansion into parts of Africa.

Mussolini outlawed opposition

Mussolini did not tolerate people disagreeing with him or his fascist party. He used secret police and had strong military support. He even had his own military force called the Blackshirts. The Blackshirts murdered and tortured people who opposed Mussolini. Many people lived in fear of Mussolini's dictatorship. Like Hitler, Mussolini was a **ruthless** leader.



Adolf Hitler (left) and Benito Mussolini (right)
after their last meeting, April 1943
Courtesy, Australian War Memorial P02018.203

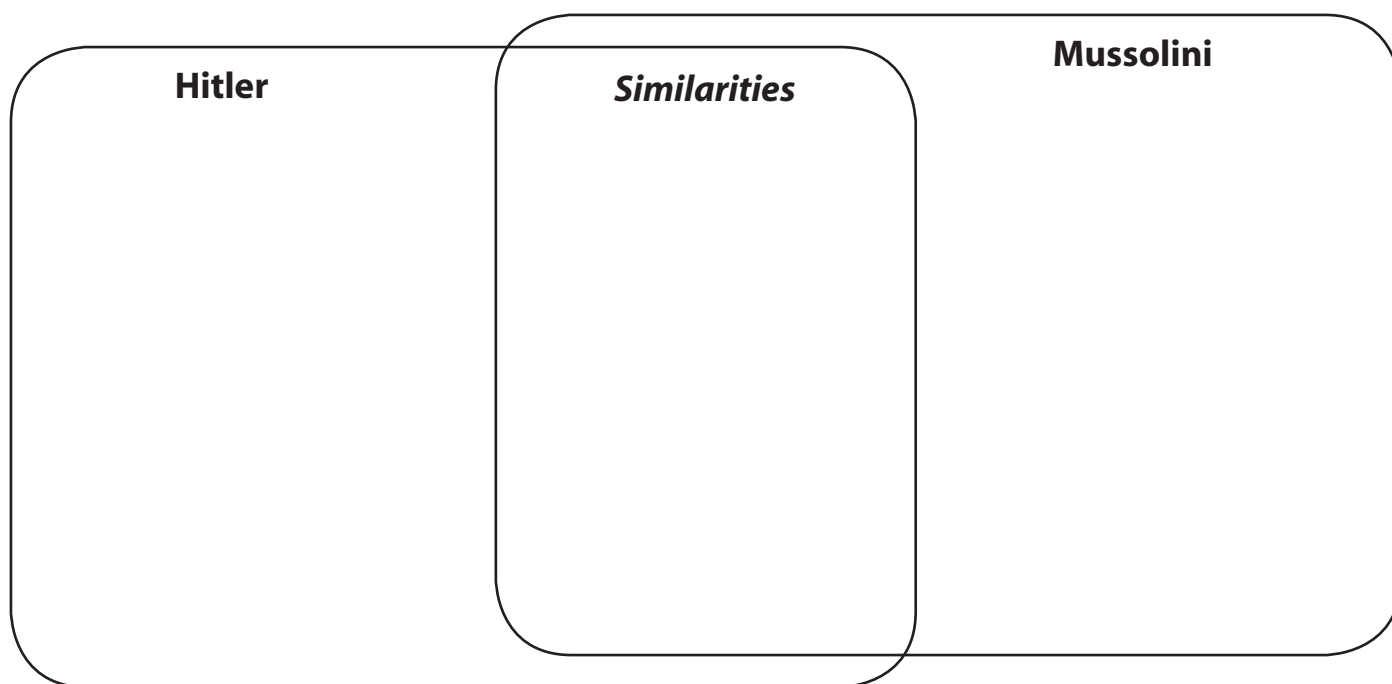
Hitler and Mussolini

 You may need to refer to the Resource sheets, 'Adolf Hitler' and 'Benito Mussolini'.

- 1 Use the word bank to fill in the diagram below. Write things similarities between Hitler and Mussolini in the centre where the boxes overlap. In the outer parts, write things that are different.

Word bank

dictator secret police propaganda Jews quash opposition Italian
 German leader charismatic invaded Blackshirts perfect race
 powerful chancellor Prime Minister



- 2 Look at the photo on the Resource sheet and read the caption. The photo is primary evidence because it was taken at the time Hitler and Mussolini met.

Write three things you notice about this photo. For example, you could write about the people in the background.

- _____
- _____
- _____

Objectives

- To become familiar with background information about the Nazi Party
- To understand how the Nazi Party gained power
- To learn about the Hitler Youth

Prior knowledge

An awareness of how the Treaty of Versailles affected Germany (see Unit 1) would help students' understanding of this unit.

Background

The Nazi Party grew from a minor extreme right wing party in 1919 to one with millions of supporters in 1939. Once under Hitler's leadership, it ruthlessly quashed opposition and indoctrinated thousands. Its growth was greatly aided by German dissatisfaction with the terms of the Versailles Treaty and the high unemployment levels Germany experienced during the Great Depression.

Starter activity

Explore the idea of indoctrination by asking questions such as:

- Have people ever made you believe that something is the best thing in the world?
- How did these people make you believe this? For example, did they show you glossy photos, play great music or have a special group they wanted you to join?
- Did these people allow you to ask any questions?

Now provide students with the following definition of **indoctrination**:

Indoctrinate means to fill a person's mind with beliefs and to not let a person question those beliefs.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'The National Socialist German Workers' Party', provides background information on the Nazi Party's rise to power. It also introduces students to the machinery the party had in place to quash any opposition.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'The Nazi Party', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'The Nationalist Socialist German Workers' Party'. Students will identify statements as true or false, and complete a cloze activity.

The Activity sheet, 'Nazi Youth', provides information about Hitler Youth. Students will match terms to definitions, and some students might want to use a dictionary. Then students will complete comprehension questions about the information on the page.

The Activity sheet, 'Nuremberg Rally – a secondary document', asks students to respond to an illustration of German youth at the 1934 Nuremberg Rally. Make sure students understand the difference between a primary source and a secondary source.

The Activity sheet, 'Two different perspectives', provides contrasting perspectives about living in Germany – one from a German teenager in 1934, and another from a Jewish German teenager in 1939. Students will answer questions about the teenagers' stories.

Extension idea

Ask students to imagine they are Jewish teenagers in Germany in the 1935. Their best friend is German, and has just joined the Hitler Youth group or the League of German Girls. Have students write a letter to their friend, asking why they joined this group and explaining how they feel about it. Students could also work in pairs to reply to one another's letters.

The National Socialist German Workers' Party

The **Nazi Party** is the shortened name of the National Socialist German Workers' Party. It was an extreme right-wing political party that began in 1919, with only fifty members. Adolf Hitler became the leader of the Nazi Party in 1921.

The Nazi Party claimed that the Weimar Republic (the German government) should not have signed the Treaty of Versailles. The Nazi Party gained popularity by blaming the Weimar Republic for Germany's economic losses. Germany had very high levels of unemployment during the Great Depression. The Nazi Party promised that it could create more employment for German people.

In 1933, the Nazi Party was the largest party in the German parliament. By 1939 when WWII began, it had millions of supporters.

What was the Weimar Republic?

In 1919, a national assembly met in the German town of Weimar and formed a new German constitution. They wanted to form a democratic government for Germany.

A German parliament called the Reichstag was established. Germans could now vote for their own representatives to govern them. This new democracy was named the Weimar Republic.

Crushing of opposition

Hitler insisted that people be loyal to him. He made every German soldier swear an oath of loyalty. Under Hitler's leadership, the Nazi Party made Germany into a police state. Secret police were used to control people's lives. Hitler used the SA (commonly known as Brownshirts), the SS (The Schutztaffel, meaning protective squadron) and the Gestapo to crush any opposition.

The Brownshirts were young unemployed men who beat and killed enemies of the Nazi Party. The SS was a powerful military group set up to protect Hitler. SS members either killed Hitler's opponents or sent them to concentration camps. The Gestapo was the Nazi Party's secret police force. The Gestapo had no respect for individual rights and sent thousands of people to concentration camps.

The Nazi Party



- 1 Read the Resource sheet, 'The National Socialist German Workers' Party'. Write **true** or **false** for each statement in the table below.

Statement	True or false?
The Nazi Party is the shortened name of the National Socialist German Workers' Party.	
The Nazi Party was an extreme right-wing political party.	
In 1919, the German government was called the Third Reich.	
In 1933, the Nazi Party was only a small political party.	
The Gestapo was the Nazi Party's secret police force.	
The SS was a powerful military group set up to protect Hitler.	
The Gestapo sent thousands of people to concentration camps.	

- 2 Use the word bank to complete the information below.

Hitler forced people to be _____ to him. Every German _____ had to swear an oath of loyalty to him. Under Hitler's _____, the Nazi Party made Germany into a _____ state. People's lives were _____ by secret police. Hitler used the SA (commonly known as _____), the SS (The Schutztaffel) and the _____ to crush any opposition.

Word bank

Brownshirts
controlled
Gestapo
leadership
loyal
police
soldier

- 3 Explain why the popularity and power of the Nazi Party was increased by the Great Depression.

Nazi Youth

The Nazi Party believed that Germany's future lay with its young people. German boys aged thirteen to eighteen were expected to join the Hitler Youth Group. Younger boys were expected to join a junior Nazi group. Teenage girls were expected to join the League of German Girls. A lot of physical training was given in these groups.

Both boys and girls were **indoctrinated** with Nazi propaganda. Parents who didn't let their children join the Hitler Youth risked imprisonment.

What members of Nazi Youth groups were taught

- The Treaty of Versailles was totally unfair.
- Jews and other non-Aryans were inferior.
- An Aryan race would become the master race.
- Adolf Hitler would make Germany a powerful nation.
- Nazis would rule the world.
- Germany needed more Lebensraum (living space).
- How to use weapons.



1 Write each term beside the correct definition:

expected, imprisonment, indoctrinated, physical, risked.

- a) being put into prison _____
- b) to do with the body _____
- c) made to believe something _____
- d) did something that was dangerous _____
- e) thought that something should happen _____

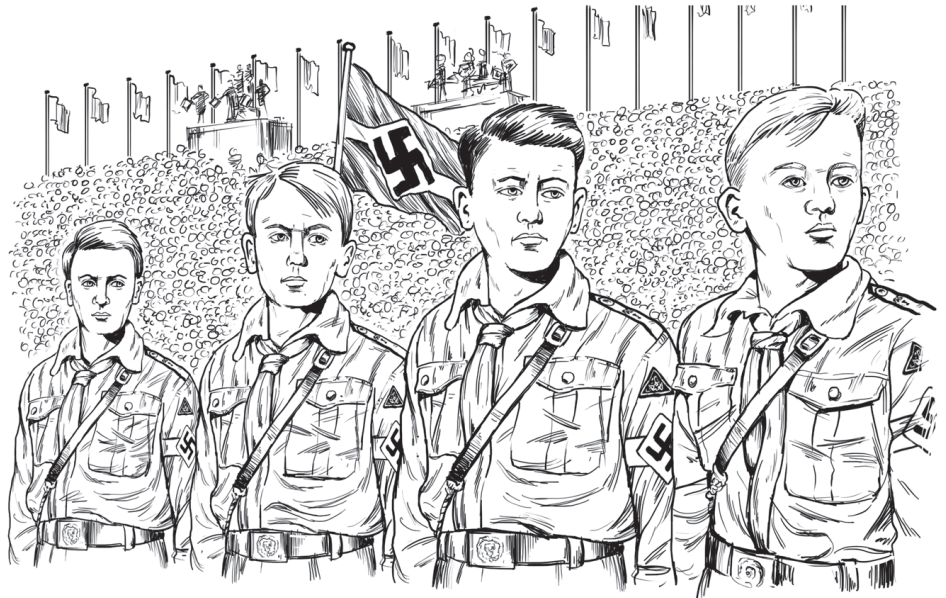
2 What were both German boys and girls indoctrinated with?

3 What could happen to parents who didn't let their children join a Nazi Youth group?

Nuremberg Rally – a secondary document

A secondary document is a piece of writing, a photo or an illustration that is created **after** an event has taken place.

The drawing shows German Youth at the famous 1934 Nuremberg Rally, which was attended by over a million people. Hitler used this rally to convince people that he and the Nazi Party would create a superior German nation.



The drawing is a **secondary** document because it was drawn **after** the 1934 Nuremberg Rally – it is an artist's interpretation of the event.

-  **1** Circle the words in the box at the right that you think are associated with the drawing.

Hitler Italy Rally Nazis Mussolini
Nuremberg speech 1934

- 2** Write two sentences about what it would have been like to be at the Nuremberg Rally.

Example:

*I think it would have been very interesting
to be at the Nuremberg Rally because
I would have heard Adolf Hitler's speech.*

Remember that a **sentence** starts with a **capital letter** and ends with a **full stop**. A sentence must contain a **verb** (doing word).

Two different perspectives

Yesterday I joined Hitler's Youth group. Mum didn't want me to but Dad said he wasn't going to risk prison. He said that Germany has suffered enough and that it looks like Hitler will stop us having to pay war debts. Anyway, I wanted to join. I want to wear a uniform and really push myself with physical training, go on special camps and make new friends. One day, I want to join the Nazi Party. I really like our Führer. He's brilliant – a fantastic speaker. He's going to make Germany the best country in the world.



**Karl, 15-year-old
German, 1934**



**Harry, 16-year-old
Jewish German, 1939**

I used to love living in Germany but now I'm scared to leave our house. Whenever I go out I have to wear a Star of David badge. People shout at me and tell me I'm a dirty Jew. Dad says it's getting too dangerous to live here. Hitler keeps giving speeches about how Jews are inferior. What really hurts is that most of my German friends won't talk to me anymore. I really worry about Mum. Since her friends had their shop windows smashed, she won't leave the house. I heard her telling Dad some of her friends don't answer her phone calls. She thinks they've been sent to concentration camps.

1 Write down three reasons why Karl wanted to join Hitler Youth.

2 Why do you think Karl liked Hitler?

3 What does Harry have to wear whenever he lives the house?

4 Why do you think Harry has to wear this?

Teacher's notes – Outbreak of war and Australia's response

Achieve!

Objectives

- To identify the immediate cause of WWII
- To explore Britain and France's declaration of War on Germany
- To present Menzies' response to the declaration of war
- To develop research skills

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge is required for this unit.

Background

On the 1st September, 1939, Germany invaded Poland. This contravened the terms of the Munich Agreement. Consequentially, on the 3rd September, 1939, Britain and France declared war on Germany. On the same date, the Australian Prime Minister, Robert Menzies, announced that because Britain was at war, Australia would also be at war.

Starter activity

Introduce the concept of Britain as Australia's mother country prior to WWII. Explain to students that when WWI started, it was automatically assumed that if Britain was at war, Australia was also at war. At the start of WWII, the Australian government also supported 'the mother country.' However, after the bombing of Pearl Harbour, there was a shift in attitudes towards supporting Britain.

Facilitate a discussion around the question:

Why did Australians look to Britain as 'the mother country' before and at the start of WWII?

Answer: Most non-Indigenous Australians were descendants of Britain. The majority of Australians viewed Australia as part of the British Empire. Australia's political and legal systems were very similar to Britain's. Australia also had strong economic ties with Britain.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, '1939 Invasion of Poland', outlines Hitler's invasion of Poland, and Britain and France's subsequent declaration of war. It also presents Menzies' response to Britain's involvement. You could have the students locate each country mentioned on a world map.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'The start of World War II', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, '1939 Invasion of Poland'. Students will complete a definition exercise and comprehension questions.

On the Activity sheet, 'Australia's response', students will explore further the information about Australia's reaction on the Resource sheet, '1939 Invasion of Poland'. Students will identify given statements as true or false and complete a cloze comprehension activity.

The Activity sheet, 'Opinions about Australia going to war', asks students to respond to two different views about Australia entering WWII.

On the Activity sheet, 'Forming alliances', students will complete exercises about the major Axis powers and Allies in the early years of WWII.

Answers: a countries, b bombing, c declare, d entered, e Sweden, f joined

Extension ideas

- Students could find Prime Minister Menzies's speech from 3rd September, 1939. This speech begins: 'It is my melancholy duty ...'
Students will find these websites useful:
www.menziesvirtualmuseum.org.au/1930s/1939.html
www.awm.gov.au/encyclopedia/prime_ministers/menzies.asp
Ask students to write down the first sentence of the speech, and explain what they think it means.
- Ask students to imagine that it is 3rd September, 1939 and they have just heard Menzies' speech. Remind students that in 1939, Australia and Britain were closely linked and that Australia had a strong import and export trade with Britain. Have students draw a self portrait with a caption explaining why or why not Australia should follow Britain to war.

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

1939 Invasion of Poland

In 1938 Neville Chamberlain, the British Prime Minister, signed a pact with Adolf Hitler called The Munich Agreement. It allowed Hitler to keep territory in Czechoslovakia, and Hitler claimed he would not take any more territory.

In 1939, Germany signed the Nazi–Soviet Pact with the Soviet Union. Publicly, the pact stated that the two nations wouldn't attack each other for ten years, and that the Soviet Union would exchange raw materials for manufactured German products. Secretly, the pact stated that Poland would be divided up between Germany and the Soviet Union.

Hitler was warned that if Germany broke the terms of the Munich Agreement and invaded Poland, Allied forces would declare war against Axis powers.

Hitler ignored the Munich Agreement and invaded Poland on 1st September, 1939. On 3rd September, 1939, Britain and France declared war on Germany.

Polish military forces were not strong enough. On the 27th September, 1939, Poland surrendered to Germany. Hitler's invasion of Poland was the immediate cause of WWII, and marks the beginning of WWII in Europe.

Major Axis powers:

- Germany
- Italy
- Japan

Major Allied forces at the start of WWII:

- Britain
- France
- Poland

Joining the Allied forces:

- The Soviet Union joined in 1941, after Germany invaded Russia (a major Soviet Union country).
- The USA joined after the bombing of Pearl Harbour in 1941.

Australia's reaction

On the 3rd September, 1939, the Australian Prime Minister, Robert Menzies, made a famous speech. He announced that Australia was at war with Germany because Britain had declared war on Germany. Menzies said Germany was taking countries by force and it had to be stopped.

In 1939, Britain was viewed as 'the mother country' of Australia. Australia was part of the British Empire and many Australians believed that Australia should support Britain. However, not every Australian agreed with Menzies' decision. Some thought the war was too far away for Australia to be involved.

The start of World War II



Read the Resource sheet, '1939 Invasion of Poland'.

1 Write each term beside the correct definition:

claimed, declared, ignored, pact, surrendered.

a) took no notice of _____

b) agreement _____

c) announced _____

d) gave into _____

e) stated _____

2 Who was the British Prime Minister in 1938?

3 What is the name of the pact the British Prime Minister signed with Adolf Hitler?

4 What is the name of the pact Germany signed with the Soviet Union?

5 In what year was this pact signed? _____

6 What country did Hitler invade in 1939? _____

7 Which countries declared war on Germany on 3rd September 1939?

8 What event marks the start of WWII?

9 Do you think Australia should have agreed to go to war? Give a reason for your answer.

Australia's response

-  **1** Read the section 'Australia's reaction' on the Resource sheet, '1939 Invasion of Poland'. Write **true** or **false** for each statement in the table below.

Statement	True or false?
Robert Menzies was the Australian Prime Minister in 1939.	
Menzies thought Australia should go to war to support Britain.	
In 1939, Australia was part of the British Empire.	
In 1939, Germany was part of the British Empire.	
In 1939, all Australians believed Australia should go to war.	
In 1939, many Australians thought Britain was 'the mother country'.	

- 2** Use these words to complete the information below: **is, was, were**.

A 'mother country' _____ a person's native land or the native land of a person's ancestors. When Neville Chamberlain, the British Prime Minister, declared war on Germany in 1939, Robert Menzies, the Australian Prime Minister, _____ quick to follow. Menzies said that because Britain _____ at war, Australia _____ also at war.

Most Australians agreed with Menzies but some people _____ unhappy with his decision. People who agreed with Menzies believed that Australia should support Britain because she _____ Australia's 'mother country'. They said that Australia _____ closely linked with Britain and argued that the majority of Australians _____ originally from Britain.

Australians who disagreed with Menzies said that Australia _____ a long way from Britain. They _____ worried that Britain could not protect Australia from an invasion from Japan. They also thought that Australia should not be so closely linked to Britain.

Opinions about Australia going to war

My name is Mark. I think Australia should go to war and support Britain. Most of us have ancestors from there. We have the same culture. We have similar legal and justice systems. Their monarchs are our monarchs – Britain is our mother country.



I'm Mary. I don't want Australia to go to war. Too many Australian soldiers died in WWI. I don't want my son to fight in a war. I don't see why Australia has to be involved just because Britain is. Why do we always follow Britain anyway? I think people forget that not everyone here has ancestors from Britain. We need to be independent.



1 Write down three reasons Mark gives for supporting Britain and going to war.

- _____
- _____
- _____

2 Write down three reasons Mary gives for staying out of the war.

- _____
- _____
- _____

Forming alliances

At the start of WWII, there were two main power blocks – the **Axis** powers and the **Allies**. The major Axis powers were Germany and Italy. Japan joined them in 1940. Italy did not officially declare war against the Allies until 1940.

The major Allies were Britain, France and Poland. Australia fought with the Allies from the beginning. Russia joined them in 1941. The USA officially joined after the bombing of Pearl Harbour in 1941.

Other countries joined the Axis powers and the Allies but some countries remained **neutral** – they didn't join either the Axis powers or the Allies. Sweden and Switzerland were two countries that remained neutral.

 Use the information above to complete the following sentences.

- 1 At the start of WWII, the major Axis powers were _____

- 2 At the start of WWII, the major Allies were _____

- 3 Japan joined the Axis powers in _____.
- 4 The USA entered the war in _____ because _____

- 5 Sweden and Switzerland were two countries that were _____
- 6 Unjumble these words from the information above.
 - a) trcesouni _____
 - b) bbgmnio _____
 - c) aredecl _____
 - d) deeentr _____
 - e) denSew _____
 - f) jendoi _____

Objectives

- To understand the meaning of *propaganda*
- To learn how propaganda was used by the Nazi Party.
- To learn about the Nazi Party's 'Final Solution'.

Prior knowledge

An awareness of the rise of Hitler and the Nazi Party would be useful.

Background

Hitler's belief that Jews were 'subhuman' was revealed in his book *Mein Kampf*. Initially, people thought Hitler was crazy but as he rose to power, he gained millions of supporters. Under Hitler's leadership, the Nazi Party constantly spread propaganda which undermined, persecuted and separated Jews and other non-Aryans. The Holocaust was the genocide of millions of Jews and other people Hitler considered 'undesirable'.

'The Final Solution' refers to the Nazi policy that all European Jews be killed. This policy was developed in the early 1940s and was initially implemented by shooting Jews in the Soviet Union. From 1942, it was done in extermination camps.

Starter activity

Write the word 'Holocaust' on the board. Ask students what they think of when they hear this word, and list their ideas. Provide students with the definition:

The Holocaust refers to the genocide of millions of Jews and Gypsies, and the murder of disabled people, Jehovah's Witnesses, communists, homosexuals and other opponents of Hitler.

Explain that genocide is the deliberate and planned extermination of a race of people.

Resource sheets and Activity Sheets

The Resource sheet, 'Hitler's propaganda against Jews', defines propaganda and anti-Semitism. It also outlines how racism against Jews was spread through the media, and Hitler's persecution of Jews.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Propaganda', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'Hitler's propaganda against Jews'. Students may need a dictionary to complete the definitions exercise. They will also complete a cloze activity.

The Resource sheet, 'The Final Solution', outlines the two stages of this Nazi policy. It also points out the other groups of people victimised by the Nazis, and explains what *data* is.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Examining the Holocaust', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'The Final Solution'. Students will complete comprehension questions and a cloze activity.

The Activity sheet, 'Euphemisms', explains and provides examples of euphemisms. It also asks students to consider why Nazis used the euphemism 'The Final Solution'.

Extension ideas

- Have students select three of the words from the definitions exercise on the Activity sheet, 'Propaganda', and use each word in a separate sentence.
- The White Rose was a German resistance youth group opposed to Nazis. Students could refer to the following websites to find out more about this group.

<http://www.jewishvirtuallibrary.org/jsource/Holocaust/rose.html>

<http://www.history.com/this-day-in-history/nazis-arrest-white-rose-resistance-leaders>

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Hitler's propaganda against Jews

Propaganda is the spreading of false or misleading information to make people believe a particular thing. Under Adolf Hitler's leadership, the Nazi Party used propaganda to convince Germans that Jews were an inferior race. This racism against Jews is called **anti-Semitism**.

The Nazi Party spread its anti-Semitic propaganda through radio broadcasts, newspapers, speeches, posters and films. Films showed Jews as **subhuman** creatures who were trying to destroy German society. For example, the film *The Eternal Jew* which was made in 1940 tried to convince audiences that Jews were greedy and immoral. Other films portrayed Germans as a **superior** race.

There were televisions in Germany from 1935. They were very big and only a few people had them. Hitler had plans to use television to show what perfect German couples were like and also what happened to Nazi traitors. He wanted to have televisions in public places so that everyone could watch them.

Nazi persecution of Jews

Persecution is constant cruelty towards an individual or a group of people.

- Hitler forced Jews to wear a yellow Star of David, with the word 'Jude' (German for 'Jew'), on their clothes. The Star of David is a symbol of Jewish identity. Hitler wanted Jews to be clearly identified to everyone so that they could be imprisoned or killed.
- A haunting example of Nazi persecution is Krystallnacht. In November, 1938, Nazi mobs bashed, arrested and murdered Jews in Germany and Austria. Jewish shops had their windows smashed and synagogues were destroyed. Over 90 Jewish people were murdered. Krystallnacht is also known as the 'Night of the Broken Glass'.
- Further persecution occurred when millions of Jews were separated from their families and sent to concentration and extermination camps.



Propaganda

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Hitler's propaganda against Jews'.

1 Write each term beside the correct definition:

destroyed, inferior, misinformation, persecution, propaganda, separated, symbol.

You can use a dictionary to help.

- a) false information _____
- b) spreading of false information _____
- c) made to be apart from _____
- d) wrecked _____
- e) very bad treatment of someone _____
- f) not as good as _____
- g) a sign of something _____

2 Use the word bank to complete the following information.

Propaganda is the _____ of incorrect or misleading information to make people _____ a particular thing. Under Adolf Hitler's _____, the _____ Party used _____ to make Germans believe that _____ were an inferior _____. This _____ against Jews is called anti-Semitism.

Word bank

spreading
propaganda
Jews
leadership
race
believe
Nazi
racism

3 Why did Hitler force Jews to wear a yellow Star of David?

Did you know?

Many Germans disagreed with the Nazi Party's persecution of Jews.

‘The Final Solution’

‘The Final Solution’ is the name the Nazi Party gave to its **policy** of killing all European Jews.

In history, there is often debate about the exact dates that things were decided.

Historians are unsure of the exact date ‘The Final Solution’ policy was formed.

However, it had two distinct stages.

- **The first stage** was in 1941 when German military forces invaded the Soviet Union. The military was closely followed by German task forces who shot any Jews they found. These special task forces decided it was too difficult to continue shooting Jews, especially women and children. This led to the second stage.
- **The second stage** of the ‘Final Solution’ began at a conference (the Wannsee Conference) held in 1942, when the Nazi Party decided to establish **extermination camps**. German industrialists were forced to build them, and Jews were sent to these death camps. The Jews were forced to work and then killed with poisonous gases.

Gypsies, communists, Jehovah’s Witnesses, homosexuals, and disabled people were also sent to extermination camps. Historians have little data to indicate how many gypsies and disabled people were killed. Jews were sent to the larger death camps so there is more data about how many Jewish people were murdered.

What is data?

Data can be described as stored **facts, information** and **statistics**.

Data can help historians work out things like:

- how many soldiers died during a war
- how many people attended a conference
- how many people live in a country.

It is important to remember that data can be altered and removed.

This means that historians have to be careful when they study data.

Examining the Holocaust

 Read the Resource sheet, 'The Final Solution':

1 When and what was the first stage of 'The Final Solution'?

2 When and what was the second stage of 'The Final Solution'?

3 Apart from Jews, who else was sent to concentration camps?

4 What is **data**?

5 Why do historians have to be careful when they study data?

6 Use these words to complete the information below: *and, as, but, were*.

Concentration camps _____ extermination camps were different. Concentration camps forced Jews _____ others considered _____ 'undesirable' to work in shocking conditions. It was very difficult to survive a concentration camp _____ there were survivors. There were few survivors from extermination camps _____ these were built to exterminate people. Sometimes concentration camps _____ extermination camps were combined.

Euphemisms

 Read the Resource sheet, 'The Final Solution':

Euphemisms are words or phrases that are used to cover up or avoid unpleasant things. For example, instead of saying someone *has died*, we can say someone *has passed away* or *kicked the bucket* or *is pushing up daisies*. Euphemisms use mild language.

Some more euphemisms

- *Collateral damage*: when military forces accidentally kill civilians during a war
- *Armed intervention*: war
- *Between jobs*: unemployed
- *Going to the washroom*: going to the toilet.

 **1** Write three more euphemisms and what they actually mean. You could discuss your ideas with a partner.

2 Think about the words: **The Final Solution**.

These words are a euphemism because they cover up what the Nazi Party was really doing to Jews.

Do you think the Nazi Party would have had as many supporters if it openly said:
'We are going to murder Jews and other 'undesirable' people?'

Discuss your ideas with a partner and give at least one reason for your opinion.

Objectives

- To learn about concentration camps
- To respond to a primary document

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge is required for this unit.

Background

Much of the information on concentration camps and what happened to the people who were sent to such camps is too horrific to present to students. Therefore some details and images have been deliberately excluded from this unit. Between 1939 and 1945, Nazi concentration camps were established to imprison people the Third Reich considered to be 'undesirables'. These camps were used as slave labour units. Millions died from starvation and diseases. Many were murdered.

Starter activity

As a class, write sentences about how the students would feel if they were sent away from their families to a concentration camp. Tell students that when they were first sent to such a camp, they probably would not have known what was going to happen to them. List these words on the board to help with composing the sentences: confused, angry, scared, worried, lonely.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'What were Nazi concentration camps?' defines concentration camps and provides information about Auschwitz, the largest Nazi concentration camp. Read the sheet with the students and make sure they understand the meaning of each term shown in bold.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'About concentration camps', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'What were Nazi concentration camps?'. Students will answer comprehension questions and multiple choice questions to complete sentences.

On the Activity sheet, 'Writing sentences', students will identify subjects and verbs in given sentences, then write their own sentences about concentration camps.

The Activity sheet, 'Children in concentration camps' asks students to complete a cloze activity which provides information on children in concentration camps, and introduces David Kaplan and Anne Frank.

The Activity Sheet 'A primary source – Ebensee photo', provides a primary source photo of boys freed from a concentration camp in 1945. Students will complete questions to guide their response to this photo.

Extension ideas

- Students could work in pairs or individually to write five questions they would like to ask the boys in the photo on the Activity sheet, 'A primary source – Ebensee photo'.
- Students could write a letter to Anne Frank or David Kaplan.

What were Nazi concentration camps?

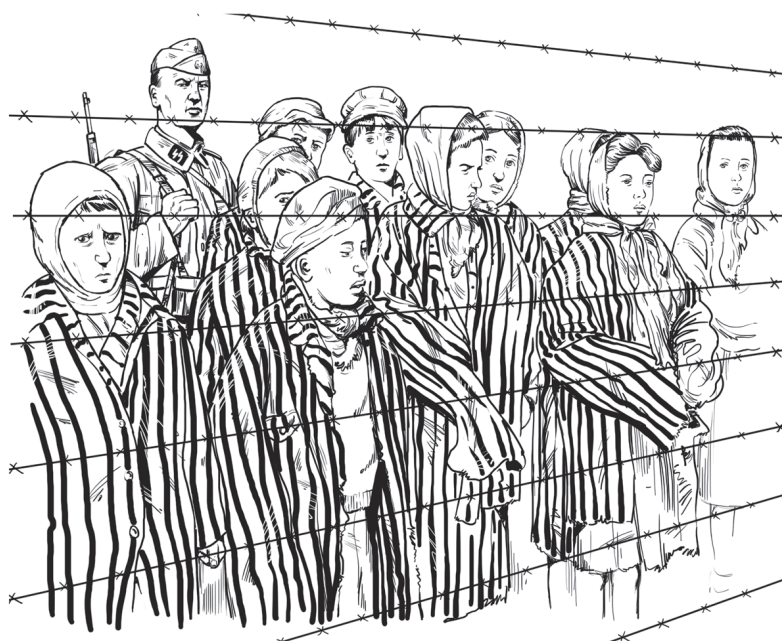
Between 1939 and 1945, Nazi Germany established many concentration camps. Concentration camps were prisons where people were made to work extremely hard. This is called **forced labour**. The camps were called concentration camps because the prisoners were **concentrated** in one place – that is, held together in one location.

At first, concentration camps were used to imprison people who disagreed with Hitler and the Nazi Party. Jehovah's Witnesses, disabled people and homosexuals were also imprisoned. However, throughout WWII, most of the prisoners were Jewish – millions were imprisoned and killed. This **genocide** of Jews is known as the **Holocaust**.

Many people in these camps died from starvation and exhaustion. Conditions were extremely harsh and only a few people survived. Nazi doctors carried out medical experiments in concentration camps. Prisoners were forced to let these doctors experiment on them.

Who guarded these camps?

These camps were run and guarded by Hitler's SS. The SS stands for the German word 'Schutztaffel'. It means a protective squadron.



Auschwitz concentration camp

Auschwitz, in Poland, was the largest concentration camp. Over a million people were killed there. Some were shot but most were killed with toxic gases. Auschwitz was used as a slave labour centre and an **extermination** centre. Bergen-Belsen and Buchenwald were the names of two smaller German concentration camps.

On 27th January, 1945, Soviet troops freed prisoners from the Auschwitz concentration camp. There is now a museum at Auschwitz in honour of the people who were imprisoned, tortured and killed there.

About concentration camps

It is important to try to recall the information you read. A good way of doing this is to read information again.



Re-read the Resource sheet, 'What were Nazi concentration camps?', and answer the following questions.

1 Why were concentration camps called concentration camps?

2 What did many people held in these camps die from?

3 Who guarded these camps?



Circle the correct answer – **a**, **b** or **c** – to complete these sentences.

4 Forced labour is when:

a) people are forced to work extremely hard.

b) people are paid for working.

c) people don't like their jobs.

5 In WWII, most German concentration camp prisoners were:

a) European.

b) German.

c) Jewish.

6 The largest concentration camp was:

a) Bergen-Belsen.

b) Buchenwald.

c) Auschwitz.

7 What does the word **Holocaust** mean?

Writing sentences

A **sentence** must contain a **subject** and a **verb**.

- The subject of a sentence tells the reader what the sentence is about.
- A verb is a doing or action word. A sentence can contain more than one verb.

 **1** Underline the subject and highlight or circle the verb (or verbs) in each sentence. The first one has been done for you.

a) Between 1939 and 1945, Nazi Germany established many concentration camps.

b) People in concentration camps were forced to work very long hours.

c) The Nazis imprisoned and killed millions of Jewish people.

d) Many people in concentration camps died from exhaustion and starvation.

e) Auschwitz, in Poland, was the largest concentration camp.

f) Over a million people were killed at the Auschwitz concentration camp.

g) On January 27 1945, Soviet troops freed prisoners from Auschwitz.

2 Write your own sentence about concentration camps. You can use the words in the box to help you.

concentration labour imprison exhaustion camps forced harsh starvation

3 Look at the illustration on Resource sheet, 'What were Nazi concentration camps?'
List at least three things this illustration shows you about concentration camps.

Children in concentration camps

 Use the word bank to complete the information below.

In WWII, a number of children _____ sent to Nazi concentration camps. These children were separated from _____ parents and usually from their brothers and sisters too. They were sent to _____ camps because of the Nazi belief that they were inferior beings.

Children who were considered too young to _____ were either shot or gassed by the _____. Some children, especially twins, were _____ for medical experiments.

Did any children survive?

Few children _____ concentration camps. Older children had a better chance of surviving because they _____ work. Many children _____ of malnutrition (poor nutrition). Others died from diseases.

Some younger children were _____ by prisoners _____. A few of these children did survive. A few older children had specific skills _____ the Nazis wanted to use.

David Kaplan

David Kaplan _____ a Lithuanian Jew. He was 11 _____ he was sent to a ghetto and 12 when he was sent to a concentration camp. David convinced the Nazis that he was a good shoemaker. He wasn't really, _____ he had some experience and someone else backed up his story. David managed to survive for four _____ in concentration camps.

Anne Frank

Anne Frank was a _____ girl. She is famous because she wrote a _____ when she was in _____, before she and her family were sent to a concentration camp. Anne Frank was only fifteen years old when she died from typhus in Bergen-Belsen. However, Anne's courage _____ always be remembered, and her story has been published.

Word bank

and
but
concentration
could
diary
died
hidden
hiding
Jewish
Nazis
survived
that
their
used
was
were
when
will
work
years

A primary source – Ebensee photo

Look carefully at the photo of the Ebensee concentration camp, in Austria. It was taken by J Heslop on 8th May, 1945, just two days after US forces freed the prisoners. It shows four boys who survived the concentration camp's harsh conditions. These boys were too weak to be evacuated straight away. Doctors gave them medicine and food to build up their strength. The boys had been given very little food and had lived in extremely crowded conditions. This photo is a **primary source** because it was taken at the actual time.



Courtesy, L.Tom Perry
Special Collections,
Harold B. Lee Library,
Brigham Young
University, Provo,
UT 84602.

- 1 What is the first thing you notice about this photo?

- 2 How do you think the boys in this photo are feeling? Are they happy, sad or confused?
Give a reason for your answer.

- 3 Discuss the photo with a partner and write a message to these boys.

Objectives

- To understand the meaning of the word *conscription*
- To learn about conscription in Australia during WWII.
- To learn about rationing in Australia during WWII
- To learn about Australian censorship in WWII.

Prior knowledge

Students need to know that WWII was fought in Asia, as well as in Europe.

Background

Under Menzies, Australia had limited conscription at the outbreak of WWII. Initially Australians were only conscripted to serve on the home front and in Australian protectorates. When Curtin took over as Prime Minister, Allied forces began to defeat the Japanese and the areas that conscripted soldiers could serve in were extended.

A scarcity of goods in Australia during the war resulted in the introduction of rationing. Civilians were asked to help the war effort by living frugally.

Throughout WWII, censorship was exercised by both the Menzies and Curtin governments.

Starter activity

Explain to students that *conscription* means forcing a person to join a military force. Outline what a military force is – the army, navy or airforce. Ask students whether they would go to war, either voluntarily or if they were conscripted, and to give reasons for their answer. Remind students that attitudes towards war were different in 1939, and lead a discussion about these differences. Explain that in 1939, most Australians still had a thought of Britain as the 'mother country'.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'Conscription and conscientious objectors', defines conscription and explores the reason for it in Australia during WWII. It also introduces students to the concept of conscientious objectors.

To complete the Activity sheet 'Conscription – yes or no?', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'Conscription and conscientious objectors'. Students will complete a definition activity and consider the pros and cons of conscription.

Read the Resource sheet, 'Rationing', with the students. It provides information about why rationing was introduced in Australia during the war years, and how it worked. Make sure students understand the meaning of each term shown in bold.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'A week of rations', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'Rationing'. Students will complete comprehension questions and consider what foods their family would need to survive on food rations for one week.

The Activity sheet, 'Censorship', provides information on censorship in Australia during WWII. Students will complete sentences about this information, and an exercise about gossiping.

Extension ideas

- Students could design a conscription poster for WWII. For ideas, they could research examples on the Internet.

Conscription and conscientious objectors

What is conscription?

Conscription means making a person enlist in a military force. Different countries have different rules about conscription.

Conscription in Australia in World War II

- 1939:** Men aged twenty years had to do military training. Young men were conscripted to defend Australia. This conscription was called home service and the troops could be sent anywhere in Australia. Troops could also be sent to Papua and New Guinea (PNG) because PNG was an Australian **protectorate**, which means PNG was protected by Australia.
- 1941:** WWII was fought in the Pacific, as well as in Europe. Japan bombed Pearl Harbour in Hawaii in December 1941, and Australians fought with Allied nations to defend the Pacific from further Japanese attacks.
- 1942:** When Japan bombed Darwin on 19th February, 1942, the Australian government realised it had to make sure there were enough soldiers to protect the country. Eighteen-year-olds now had to sign up for military service. Australian troops in PNG helped prevent Japan from using PNG as a military base, from which it could have easily invaded Australia.
- 1943:** The law was changed to allow conscripted soldiers to fight beyond Australian shores to help Allied forces protect the Pacific from Japan.

Conscientious objectors

A **conscientious objector** is someone who objects to going to war on moral or religious grounds. Conscientious objectors could apply for an **exemption** from compulsory military service. An exemption means that you don't have to follow the general rule. An exemption from compulsory military service means that you don't have to serve in a military force.

There are different types of conscientious objectors. These include:

- **pacifists**, who believe it is wrong to engage in war in any way
- people who won't carry weapons but will participate in **non-combatant** roles
- people who won't go to war but will work as **civilians** to help the war effort.

Conscription – yes or no?

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Conscription and conscientious objectors'.

1 Write each term beside the correct definition:

agreed, allowed, enlist, objects, participate.

You can use a dictionary to help.

a) doesn't agree with _____

b) join _____

c) let something happen _____

d) take part in _____

e) say yes to something _____

2 What does **conscription** mean?

3 When was Darwin bombed by Japan? _____

4 What is a **conscientious objector**?

5 What is a **pacifist**?

6 Write two reasons **supporting conscription** in wartime.

7 Write two reasons **against conscription** in wartime.

Rationing

A **ration** is a fixed allowance of a **commodity**. A commodity is a raw material or product, such as tea, sugar, spices and clothes. Rationing is the process of **distributing** (giving out) rations.

During WWII, Australians were encouraged to live **frugally**. This means they were asked to spend very little money and use fewer things. Clothing was rationed and some foods were too; for example, sugar, butter, meat and tea. Petrol, tobacco and alcohol were also rationed. Reasons for this rationing include:

- a decrease in **imported** goods
- a decrease in the **manufacturing** of textiles and clothes
- a reduced **labour force** because many people were sent to the war.

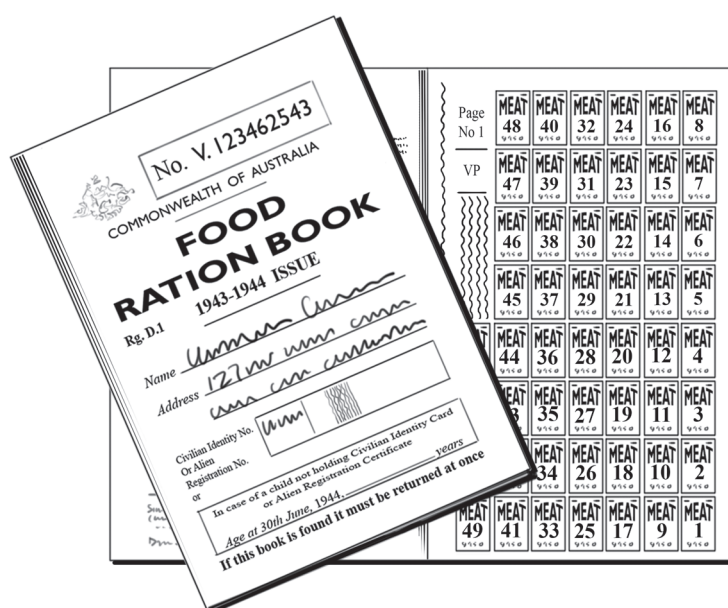
How rationing worked

In Australia, food ration books containing food coupons were given out each year. There were special food coupons for pregnant women, people who were sick and for servicemen and servicewomen who were on leave.

Sometimes different food coupons were used for different age groups. For example, in 1944, children less than nine years old didn't receive tea rations. Children who were less than five years old had more coupons for eggs.

Clothing cards were also issued annually. These had coupons that could be torn off when someone wanted to buy an item of clothing. Pregnant women and people working in some industries received special clothing coupons. People could also swap their coupons.

During this time of rationing, people had to make clothes last a long time, and also think of ways to make food go further. Even holidays were rationed – the Christmas and New Year holiday period was reduced to only three days.



A week of rations



Read the Resource sheet, 'Rationing'.

1 Complete the following sentences.

Remember that a sentence starts with a capital letter and ends with a full stop.

Make sure you put full stops at the end of each sentence.

- a) A ration is a fixed allowance of a _____
- b) A commodity is a raw material or _____
- c) During WWII, people were encouraged to live _____
- d) Sugar, butter, meat and tea were _____

2 Imagine that your family has to survive on food rations for one week.

- a) How many people are in your family? _____
- b) In the tables below, list the important foods and the quantity of each one that your family will need. Remember, you have to eat frugally. The first food has been listed for you, but you can change it if you want to.

Important foods	Quantity
eggs	one dozen

Important foods	Quantity

3 Write down two things that were rationed in WWII (other than food) that your family would need.

Censorship

Censorship is the official **control** of **information**. During WWII, the Australian government used censorship to control speeches, radio broadcasts, films, newspapers and images.

Robert Menzies was the Prime Minister when the war started. The Menzies government set up a special department called the Department of Information to control what information about the war was reported to civilians.

The letters that soldiers wrote to their friends and family were read by censors. Information that was thought to be dangerous was crossed out.

The Australian government claimed that censorship stopped important information from reaching the enemy. Censorship was also used to boost the **morale** of people at home. For example, when Darwin was bombed by Japanese forces in 1942, some details were not broadcast on the radio or printed in newspapers. This stopped people from panicking and led people to believe that the Australian government had things under control.

 **1** Read the above four paragraphs and complete the following sentences:

- a) Censorship is the official _____
- b) Robert _____ was the Prime Minister when the _____ started.
- c) Soldiers' letters from abroad were read by _____
- d) Darwin was bombed by Japanese forces in _____

Gossip is idle talk, and can include the spreading of rumours. The Australian government told citizens not to gossip about WWII because they did not want people to panic. It was also important to make sure that people did not give information to the enemy. This was a type of censorship.

- 2** Write three things that could have been gossiped about during WWII; for example, the bombing of Darwin.

Objectives

- To understand that WWII created labour shortages on the home front
- To learn how Australian civilians contributed to the war effort
- To recognise survival and recycling strategies used on the home front
- To examine a primary source photo

Prior knowledge

Other than an awareness that many Australians were engaged in overseas warfare, students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

Labour shortages and a scarcity of commodities on the WWII home front resulted in civilians constantly finding ways to contribute to the war effort. Rationing was implemented in 1942 and austerity was promoted. Civilians found ways to stretch their rations; for example, many people grew their own vegetables and fabric from unwanted clothes was used to create new clothes. Advertising persuaded civilians to use less coal and electricity.

The Commonwealth and local governments encouraged recycling, and many young people took an active role in this process. Rubber, scrap metal and newspapers were collected. Investment in war bonds was also encouraged.

Starter activity

Write the words *contribution* and *survival* on the board. Ask students to brainstorm what these words mean. Write their suggestions on the board and then provide students with the following definitions.

Contribution is the giving of time, money or help to a common cause.

Survival is managing to continue to live or exist.

Discuss *contribution* and *survival* in terms of what they might have meant to Australian civilians during the war.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'How civilians helped with the war', provides information about the ways that civilians contributed to the war effort. It also provides a primary source in the form of a photograph of the Ginger Meggs Salvage Corps.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Civilians during the war', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'How civilians helped with the war'. Students will answer comprehension questions, complete definitions and respond to a primary source.

The Resource sheet, 'Teenage perspectives', provides an insight into the lives of two Australian teenagers during wartime.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Helping and surviving', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'Teenage perspectives'. Students will list ways a teenager could contribute to the war effort and identify statements as true or false.

The Activity sheet, 'Journal entry', introduces the diary of Anne Frank. Students are asked to imagine that they are teenagers in WWII, and create a journal entry about a day in their imagined lives.

Extension ideas

- Students could research further information about the contribution of Australian civilians to the war effort, and present what they find as a multimedia report. Students could start their research with the website:
www.ww2australia.gov.au/allin/warwork.html
- Students could read *The Diary of Anne Frank*. They could also research the story of how Anne's diary came to be published. A useful website:
www.annefrank.org

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

How civilians helped with the war

Many Australian men and women were in the armed services but others also contributed to the war effort.

Civilians helped a lot on the home front. A civilian is a person who is not in the armed services.

In WWII there were **labour shortages** because so many men and women were overseas serving in the armed forces. Civilians made up this **shortfall** in labour.

Some ways civilians helped

- Helped build air-raid shelters
- Volunteered to help charities
- Volunteered their labour on farms
- Worked in factories
- Helped look after factory workers' children

Some ways civilians were thrifty

- Used scraps of material to make new clothes.
- Grew their own vegetables
- Recycled newspapers
- Didn't waste food
- Used less coal and electricity



Members of the Ginger Meggs Salvage Corps with their billy cart and salvage at the Raleigh Street State Primary School
Courtesy, Australian War Memorial 138617

In WWII there were shortages of food, petrol and other **commodities**. This meant that civilians needed to think of ways to be **thrifty**. Being thrifty means finding ways to save money. The Australian government encouraged **recycling**. Some companies held competitions to see who could collect the most scrap metal, rubber and newspapers.

The photo of the Ginger Meggs Salvage Corps and their billy cart was taken on 16th April, 1943. The billy cart was used to collect things that could be recycled. It is a primary source because it was taken during the time of WWII.

Civilians during the war

 Read the Resource sheet, 'How civilians helped with the war'.

1 Write three ways that civilians helped the war effort.

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You can work out the meanings of words by:

- using a dictionary
- thinking about how the word fits into a sentence
- asking other students what they think a word might mean.

2 Write these words beside the correct definition:

contributed, civilian, commodities, financial, thrifty.

Word	Definition
	food items or other products, like petrol
	economical, saving money
	to do with money
	a person not in the armed services
	the giving of time, money or help

3 Look at the photo on the Resource sheet.

a) How old do you think the children are? _____

b) Why has the billy cart got 'salvage corps' written on it?

c) What can you see in the billy cart?

d) What other things do you think the children collected?

Teenage perspectives

A **perspective** is a way of looking at something. Below are two teenagers' perspectives on life during WWII.



Hi, I'm Alex. I'm fifteen years old. I live with my mum and two younger sisters. Dad's off fighting somewhere in the Pacific. Mum still makes me go to school five days a week. After school, I work in our vegie plot. My sisters help me. We grow lettuce, beans, spinach and tomatoes, and we have chooks. Mum has a ration book with 112 coupons. She gets tea, butter and sugar and a little meat but that's not enough to feed us all. Each week we swap eggs with our neighbour for lemons and nectarines. I also work as a volunteer on a farm on Saturdays, digging up potatoes. It's hard work but Mum says it really helps the war effort.

Things are a bit crowded in our house – a family from Darwin is staying with us. They were evacuated after the Japanese bombing.

I wish Dad would come home soon. I really miss him. Mum worries about him all the time. So do I, but I keep telling Mum that things will be ok.



Hi there. I'm Sally. I'm fifteen years old. Dad died when I was three. I have an older brother, Hugo. He's in Europe, working as a pilot with the RAAF. My older sister Vera is working with the Australian Army Nursing Service in Egypt. Her last letter said she's really busy looking after injured soldiers. We haven't heard from Hugo for ages. Mum's worried that something's happened to him. I keep telling myself that he's not dead. My friend said he might be in a prison camp in a place called Changhi. I hope not. I've heard terrible things about that place.

Mum says we have to be strong and do our bit for the war. Sometimes I walk for ages with my friends to find scrap metal and rubber for recycling. I also mind our neighbour's kids when their mum goes to work in an ammunition factory. Mum works there too. Before the war, Mum never went out to work.

Helping and surviving

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Teenage perspectives'.

- 1 Work with a partner to think of three ways a teenager could help during WWII. Remember that if you were 18 or 19, you could go to war. If you were under 18, you could help on the home front.

- _____
- _____
- _____

- 2 Write **true** or **false** for each statement in the table.

Statement	True or false?
Teenagers had a lot of responsibilities during WWII.	
Facebook was used to communicate during WWII.	
There was rationing during WWII.	
Women worked in paid work during WWII.	
People grew their own vegetables during WWII.	
Recycling was not encouraged during WWII.	
Mobile phones were popular during WWII.	

- 3 What do you think would have been the most difficult thing about being a teenager in WWII? Give a reason for your answer.

Journal entry

A journal is a place to record information about yourself. In journals, you can write about how you feel and the things you have done. In today's world, you can have a paper journal or a digital journal. In WWII, people had paper journals. Anne Frank was a Jewish girl. She recorded her feelings and daily experiences when she and her family were forced into hiding from enemy forces. *The Diary of Anne Frank* is now a famous WWII diary.

- ✎ Imagine you are a teenager during WWII. Write a journal entry about a day in your life – any day between 1939 and 1945. Start your journal with a sentence that introduces you. You can use the word bank to help.

My Journal

Word bank

baby sitting
busy
clean
cook
dig
farm
friends
garden
hard
help
miss
school
sew
swap
tired
vegetables

Objectives

- To explore the contribution of Indigenous Australians to WWII
- To learn about two significant Indigenous people
- To examine primary source photos

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge is required for this unit.

Background

Prior to WWII, and when it began, Indigenous Australians were not officially allowed to enlist in military forces. The threat of Japanese invasion changed this. However, Indigenous members of Australian military forces generally were not paid the same amount as non-Indigenous members. Despite this, Torres Strait Islanders and Aboriginals made a significant contribution to WWII. Two well known Indigenous contributors were Leonard Waters and Reg Saunders.

Starter activity

Ask students to list the famous Indigenous people they know. Write the names on the board, and summarise why they are famous. Explain to students that Indigenous people contributed significantly to WWII by joining Australia's military forces and helping on the home front.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islanders participation', provides background information about Indigenous participation in WWII. It also introduces the Aboriginal poet Oodgeroo Noonuccal (also known as Kath Walker) who served in the Australian Women's Army Service.

The Activity sheet, 'Remembering information', provides a cloze exercise and comprehension questions about the information on the Resource sheet, 'Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islanders participation'. You could challenge students to test their memory by completing the activities without referring to the Resource sheet.

The Activity sheet, 'Northern Territory Special Reconnaissance Unit (NTSRU)', outlines the role of the NTSRU and provides a related map exercise. Students will need an atlas to complete this activity sheet.

The Activity sheet, 'Leonard Waters', provides a profile of the first Indigenous Australian to become a fully qualified pilot. Students are asked to respond to this information and to a photograph of Waters.

The Activity sheet, 'Reginald Saunders', provides profile of the first commissioned Indigenous soldier. Students are asked to respond to this information and to a photograph of Saunders graduation from the Officers' Cadet Training Unit.

Extension ideas

- Students could research Reginald Saunders and find out about his brother. Note that his brother Harry also fought in WWII and was killed on the Kokoda Trail. Students could start their research with the website:
www.awm.gov.au/exhibitions/fiftyaustralians/43.asp
- Have students research Oodgeroo Noonuccal (also known as Kath Walker), who is well known for her poetry and for her work in civil rights. Encourage students to find and read at least one of her poems. Students could also create a timeline showing important events in Oodgeroo's life. Students could start their research with the websites below, or simply type 'Oodgeroo Noonuccal' into an Internet search engine.
www.ict.griffith.edu.au/~davidt/redlandbay/oodgeroo.htm
www.library.uq.edu.au/fryer/treasures/yusuf/kath.html

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Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander participation

Before WWII began, Australia's military forces had rules that usually stopped Indigenous Australians from enlisting. The government claimed this was because Aboriginals and Torres Strait Islanders were not of European descent. In 1939, some Indigenous men were allowed to join the armed forces because they claimed to belong to different nationalities.

Effects of the threat of Japanese invasion

From 1940, attitudes towards Indigenous people joining the military began to change. The Japanese attack on Pearl Harbour, the invasion of Singapore and the bombing of Darwin meant Australia needed more soldiers. The strong threat of Japanese invasion forced the military services to allow Indigenous people to enlist.

The Australian government knew that the Japanese had contacts in Torres Strait, because many Japanese worked there on pearling boats. The government wanted to make sure that these contacts would not spy for Japan. In 1942, the Torres Strait Light Infantry Company was formed. Nearly all of its members were Torres Strait Islanders. They completed military training and worked very hard to defend the Torres Strait islands.

Indigenous women

Indigenous women also contributed to the war effort. They helped to raise money and organised parcels to send to soldiers overseas. Others enlisted in the Australian Women's Army Service and the Australian Medical Women's Army Service. The Aboriginal poet, Oodgeroo Noonuccal (also known as Kath Walker) is a famous Aboriginal who enlisted in the Australian Women's Army Service.

c1942, Brisbane, Queensland. Studio portrait of Aboriginal servicewoman, Lance Corporal Kathleen Jean Mary (Kath) Walker, of Stradbroke Island, Qld, a communication worker with the Australian Women's Army Service (AWAS).
Courtesy, Australian War Memorial P01688.001



Remembering information

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander participation'.

1 Use the word bank to complete the following information.

Word bank

armed belong claimed enlisting European Indigenous not rules Torres

Before WWII began, Australia's military forces had _____ that usually stopped _____ Australians from _____. The government _____ this was because Aboriginals and _____ Strait Islanders were _____ of _____ descent. In 1939, some Indigenous men were allowed to join the _____ forces because they claimed to _____ to different nationalities.

2 From 1940, what threat forced Australia's military services to allow Indigenous people to enlist?

3 List two ways Indigenous women helped with the war effort.

4 Name the famous Aboriginal poet who enlisted in the Australian Women's Army Service.

5 Look at the photo of Oodgeroo Noonuccal (Kath Walker) on the Resource sheet. Write two sentences about this photo. You could consider what Oodgeroo is wearing.

• _____

• _____

Northern Territory Special Reconnaissance Unit (NTSRU)

From 1941, a number of Indigenous men served overseas. However, the Northern Territory Reconnaissance Unit (NTSRU) is an example of Indigenous contribution to the war on the home front. This unit was a special task force made up of about fifty Yolngu people from East Arnhem Land. The unit's role was to defend the northern Australian coastline from Japanese spies and from Japanese attack. Because Australia is an island, it was very important for the coastlines to be protected.

 **1** What does NTSRU stand for?

2 What was the role of the NTRSU?

3 Use an atlas to locate the following cities. Label them on the map.

- Adelaide
- Alice Springs
- Brisbane
- Canberra
- Darwin
- Melbourne
- Perth
- Sydney

4 On the map, highlight the area of Australia that the NTSRU protected.



5 Explain why it was so important for this area of Australia to be protected.

Leonard Waters

In 1942, Leonard Waters joined the Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF) and trained as a flight mechanic. He then trained as a pilot. Waters was the first Indigenous Australian to become a fully qualified pilot.

Waters was assigned to Squadron 78 and served in Dutch New Guinea and Indonesia. He bombed places where Japanese troops were posted. Waters flew a kittyhawk – a type of fighter plane – and called his plane ‘Black Magic’.

In 1945 at the age of 21, Waters became a Flight Sergeant. He was awarded war medals for his bravery and has a street named after him – Len Waters Street in Canberra.



Pacific Ocean, South West Pacific Area, 1944–1945. Sergeant Leonard Victor Waters, 78 Squadron, RAAF, sitting in the cockpit of a P40N Kittyhawk, possibly ‘Black Magic’.
Courtesy, Australian War Memorial P01659.001

-  1 Write down four things you notice in the photo.

- 2 Write two sentences about Leonard Waters. Remember that a sentence starts with a capital letter, ends with a full stop, and contains a verb (doing word). Remember to proof read your sentences for any mistakes.
-

Reginald Saunders

Reg Saunders was an Aboriginal who joined the Australian Imperial Force (AIF) in 1940. He started his overseas service in Libya and was then sent to Greece. His battalion survived heavy air attacks but had to withdraw.

The battalion was sent to Crete but the ship they travelled on, the *Costa Rica*, was bombed and sank. Some soldiers, including Reg, were picked up by a destroyer. In Crete, Reg and his battalion fought bravely against constant enemy air attacks. Allied troops had to leave Crete but some troops, including Reg's, were left behind. Reg hid for a whole year in Crete and escaped in 1942.

Reg rejoined his battalion in New Guinea. His courage and strong leadership skills were noticed and he became the first commissioned Indigenous soldier. This means he was responsible for other soldiers and gave them orders. He became a platoon commander in New Guinea.



Lieutenant Reginald Saunders being congratulated by Lieutenant Tom Derrick for graduating from the Officers' Cadet Training Unit, Seymour, Victoria, 1944.
Courtesy, Australian War Memorial 083166

 **1** What is the first thing you think when you look at the photo?

2 What are the names of the people in this photo?

3 Write your own sentence about this photo.

Objectives

- To recognise the role of Australian women on the home front in WWII
- To recognise the role of Australian women abroad in WWII
- To develop skills in responding to primary documents

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge is required for this unit.

Background

During WWII, Australian women played a major role both on the home front and abroad. There was resistance to women taking on traditional male roles. However, necessity overcame this resistance. Women joined a number of organisations closely affiliated with the armed services.

Starter activity

Brainstorm what jobs the class thinks women and men should have in a war. Write the students' ideas on the board and encourage them to give reasons for their views. Explain to the students that the roles of women and men in society were very different in that time, compared to today.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'Women on the home front', outlines some of the jobs women did during WWII. It also introduces the idea that the role of women in society changed dramatically at this time. Read the sheet with the students and make sure they understand the meaning of the terms shown in bold. Ask students if they think the poster would be effective for recruiting women, and to give reasons for their opinions.

The Activity sheet, 'Jobs done by Australian women', asks students to compose a list of jobs performed by women during WWII. It also defines *acronym* and provides a table of related acronyms. To extend the activity, students could research one of the organisations listed in the table.

The Activity sheet, 'Looking at a poster and a photo', asks students to respond to the recruitment poster on the Resource sheet, 'Women on the home front'. It also provides a photo of women repairing a plane for students to respond to.

In the Activity sheet 'Australian women serving abroad', students are provided with information about nurses serving abroad and the Australian Women's Army Service. Students will answer questions about this information. Question 2 answers: a Australian, b drove, c service, d worked, e necessary, f people.

In the Activity sheet, 'Letter to a husband', students will read and respond to a wartime letter.

Extension ideas

- Have the students imagine that they are involved in WWII. Ask them to write a letter to a close friend or relative who is posted overseas for the war.
- Word building – write the words *information*, *communication* and *organisation* on the board. Explain to the students that these words are the noun forms of verbs. Work as a class to construct a verb/noun table like the one below.

Verb	Noun
inform	information
communicate	communication
organise	organisation
regulate	regulation
negotiate	negotiation
navigate	navigation

Women on the home front

Before WWII, most Australian women worked at home, raising children and doing **domestic chores**. This work was unpaid. During the war (1939–45), many men left their jobs to fight in the war. These vacant jobs were filled by women.

They included:

- working in factories, especially **munitions** factories
- working on farms
- driving army vehicles and ambulances
- working in **telecommunications**
- working as mechanics
- collecting intelligence information.

Women were usually paid less than men. During the war, many women had to make all the family decisions and deal with finances for the first time. They also had to cope with not knowing if family members who were at war were safe.

This poster is called 'Join us in a victory job.' It was made in 1943. Its purpose is to **persuade** women to join organisations during WWII. It shows women in the WRANS, AWAS, WAAAF, AWLA and AAMWS, and a munitions worker. It is a **recruitment** poster.



Join us in a victory job – poster created for the Department of National Service, 1943
Courtesy, Australian War Memorial ARTV00332

Voluntary work

Women did a lot of **voluntary** work, raising money for the war effort and sending clothes and food to soldiers overseas. One of the biggest voluntary organisations was the Australian Women's Land Army (AWLA), established in 1942. Women aged between 18 and 50 could join. The AWLA was a voluntary organisation because its members were civilians, not formally enlisted in the army. Women working in the AWLA were paid a small amount of money by farmers for jobs like planting crops, driving tractors and milking cows. Their efforts helped maintain Australia's food supply.

Jobs done by Australian women

Making a list can help you remember information. For example, if you want to remember what to buy when you go shopping, you make a list.

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Women on the home front'.

1 List six jobs Australian women did in WWII.

An **acronym** is a word formed from the **first letters** of other words.

For example, **AWLA** is an acronym for the **Australian Women's Land Army**.

2 Fill in the missing vowels in the organisations listed in the table.

3 Write each acronym beside the correct organisation:

AANS, AWAS, RANNS, WAAAF, WRANS.

Organisations women joined in WWII	Acronym
Austr_l_an W_m_n's Army Service	
_ustral_an Army N_rsing Serv_ce	
W_men's R_yal Australian N_val Service	
Roy_l A_stralian Naval Nurs_ng Service	
Wom_n's Australian A_xiliary Air F_rce	

4 List at least two acronyms for other organisations you know. Write the full name for each organisation.

Looking at a poster and a photo

Historians can find out a lot of interesting information from posters, photos and paintings.

👉 Look at the poster on the Resource sheet, 'Women on the home front'.

1 List the organisations and job this poster is recruiting for.

The photo shows members of the Women's Auxiliary Australian Air Force (WAAAF) cleaning and fixing a RAAF plane. It was taken in 1943.

2 Is this photo a **primary** or **secondary** source?
Remember, a primary source is one that was written or photographed at the time.



3 Before WWII, many people thought that women couldn't do 'men's jobs'. Do you think the women in the photo look like they're doing a good job? Give a reason for your answer.

Pearce, Australia, March 1943. Members of the Women's Auxiliary Australian Air Force cleaning and overhauling a plane of the RAAF. Courtesy, Australian War Memorial 029692

Australian women serving abroad

During WWII, many Australian women served abroad (overseas). **Nursing services** were closely linked to the Australian navy, army and air force. Women served as nurses in the Middle East, Greece and Singapore. They worked under extremely difficult conditions and often put up with the same conditions as soldiers. When hospitals weren't available, they worked in temporary medical wards. At times nurses went to the battlefields to care for wounded soldiers.

Many nurses were sent to Singapore because Singapore was an Allied base. When Japan invaded Singapore in 1942, sixty-five nurses were evacuated on the ship the *Vyner Brooke*. The Japanese bombed the ship and twelve nurses drowned. Other nurses were captured by the Japanese and shot. One nurse, Vivian Bullwinkel, pretended she was dead and survived. She lived to tell how brave her colleagues had been.

 **1** Use the information above to help you complete the following information.

- a) During WWII, women served as nurses in the Middle East, _____ and _____.
- b) Nurses worked under _____.
- c) Many nurses were sent to _____ because it was an _____.
- d) Japan invaded Singapore in _____.

The **Australian Women's Army Service (AWAS)** was formed in 1941. Women in this service worked in many roles. They drove vehicles and worked as clerks, interpreters, typists and telegraph operators. Some also worked as guards. About 350 women in this service were sent overseas. Many people believed that women should not work outside of the home, but the AWAS was considered necessary because it allowed more men to take on combat roles.

 **2** Unjumble these words from the information above.

- | | |
|--------------------|-----------------|
| a) liantraus _____ | b) vedro _____ |
| c) viceser _____ | d) kedwor _____ |
| e) ssarynece _____ | f) oplepe _____ |

Letter to a husband

 Read this letter from a woman to her husband who was fighting overseas in WWII.

Dear Joe,

I miss you so much and hope you are safe. The children miss you too. We were all so happy when we got your letter. I've started working in a munitions factory. A lot of women are now working outside of home because there just aren't enough men left here to do all the jobs that need to be done. When I'm not at the factory, I'm trying to keep up with the housework. The children are doing more chores now, and they're getting used to me being the boss of the house. You'd be so proud of them. Sally's been knitting scarves to put in comfort parcels to send to soldiers who are far away from home. She's hoping you get one of her scarves. Robbie's joined a salvage corps. You should see some of the things he collects!

My darling, we only hear bits of news about Singapore and I can't imagine what you're going through. I want you to know that everything is fine here. I'm learning how to do new things every day.

Love always,

Rosie xxx

PS – We're growing our own vegies.

- 1 Where has Rosie started working? _____
- 2 What reason does Rosie give for so many women working outside the home?

- 3 Why do you think Rosie has to be 'the boss of the house'?

- 4 Imagine you are Rosie. Write three things you think would be important to tell Joe.

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- | | |
|--|-----------------------------|
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